

VentureMiner AI

Release Management

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Table of Contents

Document 30 — Release Management

Table of Contents

1. Purpose & Scope
2. Release cadence
3. Release contents
4. Pre-release checklist
5. Release cut
6. Canary & promotion
7. Release notes
8. Customer comms
9. Rollback
10. Hotfixes
11. Support
12. Post-release
13. Appendix
 - 13.1 Revision history
 - 13.2 Cross-references

Document 30 — Release Management

How a release is cut, communicated, and supported. The contract for what a release means to engineering, product, sales, support, and customers.

Table of Contents

1. Purpose & Scope
2. Release cadence
3. Release contents
4. Pre-release checklist
5. Release cut
6. Canary & promotion
7. Release notes
8. Customer comms
9. Rollback
10. Hotfixes
11. Support
12. Post-release
13. Appendix

1. Purpose & Scope

This document is the contract for release management. It defines what a release is, how it ships, and how the rest of the company supports it.

2. Release cadence

- Weekly release tag for engineering.
- Monthly product release that bundles weekly tags into a customer-facing release.
- Ad-hoc for security hotfixes.

3. Release contents

Each release is a coherent unit of work:

- A versioned set of PRs.
- A migration plan (if any).
- A flag rollout plan.
- A rollback plan.
- A monitoring plan.

4. Pre-release checklist

- ☐ Scope is locked.
- ☐ All acceptance criteria met.
- ☐ NFRs green on staging.
- ☐ Security review (if in scope).
- ☐ Documentation updated.
- ☐ Migration tested in staging.
- ☐ Rollback tested in staging.
- ☐ Release notes drafted.
- ☐ Customer comms drafted.
- ☐ On-call informed.

5. Release cut

1. Tag vX.Y.Z on main.
2. Build & deploy to canary.
3. Soak 24h.
4. SLO review; auto-promote or hold.

6. Canary & promotion

- 10% of traffic for 24h.
- Monitoring: SLO burn rate, error rate, latency, AI verifier pass rate.
- Decision: auto-promote if green; hold for human review if not.
- Promotion: full rollout within 1h of decision.

7. Release notes

- Auto-generated from PR titles + labels.
- Manually edited for clarity, customer framing, and screenshots.
- Published to changelog.ventureminer.ai and as an in-app banner.
- Tagged with the product area (Discovery, Validation, Reporting, etc.).

8. Customer comms

- Weekly tags: internal only.
- Monthly release:
- In-app banner on the new version.

- Hotfixes: status page + email for SEV-1/2.

9. Rollback

- Automatic on health-check fail.
- Manual via argocd app rollback or feature flag flip.
- Backout plan documented per release.
- Post-rollback review for any non-trivial rollback.

10. Hotfixes

- For SEV-1 and SEV-2 only.
- Branch from main; expedited gates; direct to prod.
- Hotfix review by on-call + second engineer.
- Hotfix notes added to the next release.

11. Support

- Tier 1: in-product help center + chatbot.
- Tier 2: support engineers; business hours; < 8h response (paid), < 48h (Free).
- Tier 3: engineering; on-call.
- CSM: Enterprise customers; named CSM; monthly QBR.

12. Post-release

- T+1 day: SLO compliance review.
- T+7 days: feature adoption check.
- T+30 days: KPI impact (where measurable).
- T+release+1: retrospective on release process (if any failures).

13. Appendix

13.1 Revision history

v0.5	2026-07-20	Doc Team	All sections drafted
v1.0	2026-07-20	Doc Team	First approved version

13.2 Cross-references

- DevOps: Document 23.
- CI/CD: Document 24.

End of Document 30 — Release Management. A release is a promise; release management is how we keep it.